

90.3 VERBS WITH COMPLEMENTS

The entire infinitive clause cannot be left out after verbs that have complement clauses (phrases that complete their meaning), such as: "advise," "afford," "be able," "choose," "decide," "expect," "hate," "hope," "love," "need," and "prefer." "To" must be used after these.

**We want to see a band tonight,
but we really can't afford to.**



FURTHER EXAMPLES

I tried to get to the front of the crowd, but I wasn't able to.



I had piano lessons as a child, but I didn't choose to.



You could bring some snacks along, but you don't need to.



I have never been to the opera, but I would love to.



90.4 "WANT" AND "WOULD LIKE"

The "to" of the infinitive clause is not usually dropped after "want" or "would like."

**He asked if I wanted to go,
and I said I would like to.**



In "if" clauses, however, "to" can be used on its own or the whole infinitive can be dropped after "want" or "would like."

**You can come with us if you { want.
want to.**

The "to" cannot be dropped in a negative clause.

Don't go to the concert if you don't want to.

FURTHER EXAMPLES

We could play golf this weekend, if you want.



I asked my friends to play, but they didn't want to.

